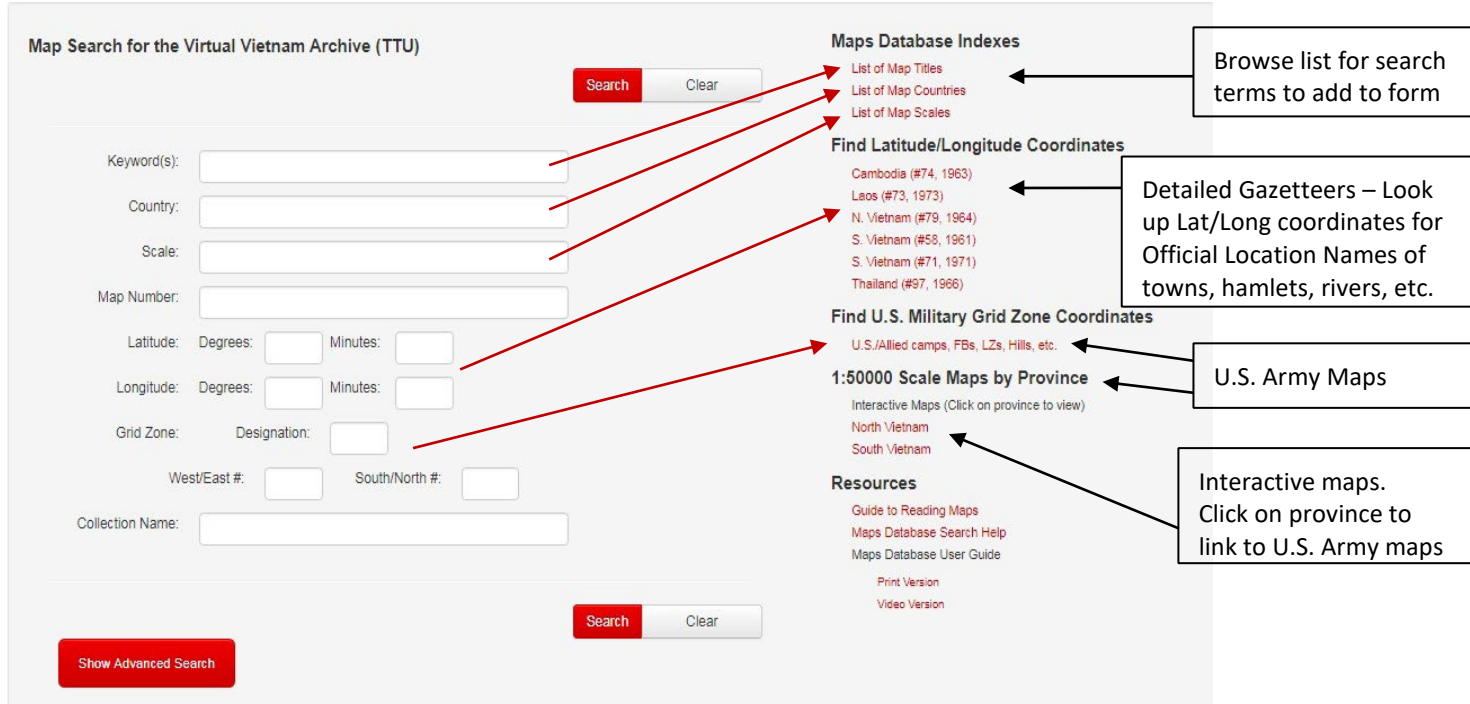


Using the Vietnam Archive Maps Database

VNCA has a complete set of the era **U.S. Army 1:50000 maps** – they are digitized and freely available online (i.e., U.S. government and military materials are in the public domain) using our Map Search form in the Virtual Vietnam Archive (see instructions below, the attached Map Search guide and our YouTube video guide:). NOTE: Each grid square is 1 square kilometer ; maps are roughly 26x26 grids/kilometers.

Go to the Virtual Vietnam Archive : <https://vva.vietnam.ttu.edu>

Click on the link for **Map Search**. [To return to the **Search Home** page, click the Home icon: ].



The screenshot shows the 'Map Search for the Virtual Vietnam Archive (TTU)' form. On the left is a search form with fields for Keyword(s), Country, Scale, Map Number, Latitude (Degrees/Minutes), Longitude (Degrees/Minutes), Grid Zone (Designation), West/East #, South/North #, and Collection Name. There are 'Search' and 'Clear' buttons. On the right is a sidebar with 'Maps Database Indexes' (List of Map Titles, List of Map Countries, List of Map Scales), 'Find Latitude/Longitude Coordinates' (Cambodia (#74, 1963), Laos (#73, 1973), N. Vietnam (#79, 1964), S. Vietnam (#58, 1961), S. Vietnam (#71, 1971), Thailand (#97, 1966)), 'Find U.S. Military Grid Zone Coordinates' (U.S./Allied camps, FBs, LZs, Hills, etc.), '1:50000 Scale Maps by Province' (Interactive Maps (Click on province to view), North Vietnam, South Vietnam), and 'Resources' (Guide to Reading Maps, Maps Database Search Help, Maps Database User Guide, Print Version, Video Version). Callout boxes point to these sections: 'Browse list for search terms to add to form' points to the indexes; 'Detailed Gazetteers – Look up Lat/Long coordinates for Official Location Names of towns, hamlets, rivers, etc.' points to the coordinates section; 'U.S. Army Maps' points to the 1:50000 Scale Maps by Province section; and 'Interactive maps. Click on province to link to U.S. Army maps' points to the Interactive Maps link.

To browse/search through all of the Laos maps, in the right-hand menu, click on **Map Countries Index**; scroll down and click on **Laos** (157).

From the main **Map Collection Search Page**, you also have the option to go Find Coordinates in the righthand menu and click on Laos. This will take you to links for: Title: Laos: Official Standard Names, Gazetteer (360), 01 May 1973.

To search by **Grid Zone** on the U.S. Army 1:50000 maps enter the coordinates into the three fields.

For example, FSB Bastogne is YD620095, so enter as:



The screenshot shows the 'Grid Zone' search fields. The 'Designation' field contains 'YD'. The 'West/East #' field contains '620'. The 'South/North #' field contains '095'. A callout box points to the 'Designation' field with the text 'Use Capital Letters: e.g., YD'.

List of Fire Support Bases (FSB) and Landing Zones (LZ) used in South Vietnam during the Vietnam War
Item#: 25720204001 <https://www.vietnam.ttu.edu/virtualarchive/items.php?item=25720205001>

View the Detailed Map

The Search Results will display the item record information for the map(s) with map information and links to various file types. You may click on the thumbnail image to see a slightly larger picture of the map, however zoom-in options do not work with the thumbnail. Instead, click on one of the map file links listed inside the item record.

NOTE: The **full size PDF file** gives the greatest Zoom-In capability to easily see map details (see next page for screenshot).

View Detailed Map and Adjacent Maps

Click on the Map Title in the item record. Then click on the FULL SIZE PDF file for detailed zoom view.

To move to adjacent maps, click on the red map sheet number links.

The screenshot displays the 'Pleiku' map item record. At the top, there is a 'Summary' section with the following details: Item Number 6636-4, Language English, Number of Pages 2, Type Map, Author(s) Army Map Service, and Physical Location Section 11, Drawer 12, Folder 2. To the left of the summary is a sidebar with links to Summary, Files (8), Dates (2), Names (1), and Components. The main area features a map grid with a central map thumbnail and surrounding red map sheet numbers (6537-2, 6637-3, 6637-2, 6536-1, 6636-2, 6636-3, 6636-2). Below the map grid is a 'Files' section with four links: 'Full Size PDF', 'PDF 8.5x11', 'Large Size', and 'Medium Size'. A fifth link, 'PDF Vietnamese Version', is also present. Arrows point from the red map sheet numbers to a text box stating 'Click on any red map # to move to adjacent maps.' Another arrow points from the 'Full Size PDF' link to a text box stating 'For best map detail use the Large PDF file'.

Pleiku [Edit](#)

Summary

Item Number 6636-4
Language English
Number of Pages 2
Type Map
Author(s) Army Map Service
Physical Location Section 11, Drawer 12, Folder 2

Summary >
Files 8 >
Dates 2 >
Names 1 >
Components >

6537-2 6637-3 6637-2
14° 0' x 108° 0' W 14° 0' x 108° 15' E
6536-1 6636-1
6536-2 6636-3 6636-2
13° 45' x 108° 0' W 13° 45' x 108° 15' E
Zoom Out: ND49-9

Files

[Full Size PDF](#) [PDF 8.5x11](#) [Large Size](#) [Medium Size](#) [PDF Vietnamese Version](#)

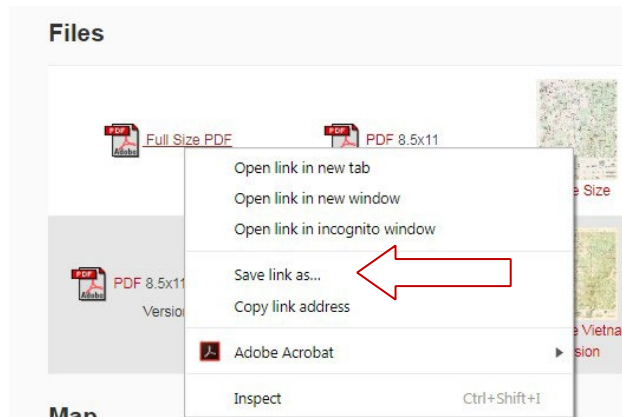
Click on any red map # to move to adjacent maps.

For best map detail use the Large PDF file

Download the Map File

In the main record with the list of file links: **right-click** on the file size/type you want (if you are going to print it use the large JPEG or full size PDF version for the best resolution), then from the menu choose **“Save Target As”** or **“Save Link As”** and save it to a location on your computer – it will automatically save with the unique Map Number. (NOTE: each browser uses a slightly different menu terminology).

NOTE: The larger the file, the longer it will take to load, so only download 1-2 files at a time.



Resource for Map Coordinates

You can enter either Latitude/Longitude Coordinates OR Grid Zone Coordinates for a specific search.

We have a list of both coordinate types which is compiled by a Vietnam veteran from AARs, etc.

Click on this link:

Title:

List of Fire Support Bases (FSB) and Landing Zones (LZ) used in South Vietnam during the Vietnam War [Updated September 2024] (Item Number: 25720206001) [William Kindred Collection]

Permalink:

<https://www.vietnam.ttu.edu/virtualarchive/items.php?item=25720206001>

1:25000 Pictomap Series

We also have an almost complete set of the era **U.S. Army 1:25000 Pictomap series**. The Map Sheet# corresponds to the 1:50000 sheets, with a N and S for each. The Pictomap series is not available online, but we have the digitized files available upon request. Search for the map you need using our online resources for the 1:50000 maps, then email with the Map Sheet#(s) you want and we will email the PDF files to you.